

Group Feature Design

Groups are similar to Pages in FB. They're simply an unincorporated group (of users) that is usually interest, connection, or topic-focused.

Every Group must have a unique name. No Group may have the name of another Profile (Personal, Professional, or Business). You can't have a Roof Maxx Business profile and a Group called "Roof Maxx." You could, however, have a Group called "Roof Maxx Dealers" or "Roof Maxx Customers," or...

Any Profile type can create a Group. Any Profile type can be in a group (so long as that Group creator (owner) or moderator has selected all Profile types as eligible for membership).

Groups have a Creator (one), Moderators (possibly several), and Members (many). The Creator is always a Moderator unless removed as a Moderator. Can only be removed if there is at least one other Moderator.

Only Control or higher may create a Group. Moderators must be Control or higher. Members must be on a paid plan.

Groups will have a Group Score and possibly a Culture Score (or similar score type). Group Score is simply the average of all Group Members' Personal Scores (including the Creator and Moderators).

Every Group will have a Profile similar to other Profiles. It will display basic group info as per below (and Group Score and Culture Score)

Group Creation Requirements:

1. Group Name
2. Group Avatar
3. Bio or Description (character limited)
4. State
5. Type (Circle, Local, Network, Affinity group, or Cohort) or however we are going to designate different kinds of groups
6. Creator name
7. Moderator name(s)
8. Hurdle rate, if any
9. Minimum Score Criteria (could be N/A or Any). Or it could be a real number, for example 3.7.

We can use groups or communities that follow the naming conventions of other platforms, or we can come up with something more platform-specific, like Reddit did. I asked Perplexity to help me choose a word or a strategy:

Recommendations for Your Local Social Network

Given your platform's goal of encompassing diverse types of human connections—interests, demographics, political persuasions, genealogical ties, geographic proximity, and cryptic combinations—consider these approaches:

Single-Term Solution:

"Circles" offers the best balance of versatility, modern resonance, and intuitive understanding. It works equally well for:

- Interest circles (photography enthusiasts)
- Demographic circles (young professionals)
- Geographic circles (neighborhood residents)
- Purpose circles (environmental activists)
- Identity circles (cultural heritage groups)

The term is platform-neutral, carries positive connotations of inclusion and trust, and has precedent in successful social platforms.

Two-Tier Solution:

If one word proves limiting, consider a hierarchical approach:

- **Communities** (broad, encompassing term) containing multiple **Circles** (specific, focused groups)
- **Networks** (overarching connections) organized into **Pods** (small, intimate groups)
- **Hubs** (central gathering points) with various **Crews** (action-oriented teams)

Contextual Solution:

Allow different terms for different types of groups:

- **Circles** for interest-based connections Buckeyes Football Home-brewing
- **Locals** for geographic communities XYZ Neighborhood
- **Networks** for professional connections AICPA
- **Affinity Groups** for identity-based connections BLM
- **Cohorts** for time-based or experience-sharing groups AA, Cancer Survivors, Veterans (American Legion Post #12345)

Innovation Solution:

Create a platform-specific term that becomes synonymous with your brand, as Reddit did with "subreddits." This could be:

- **Nexus** (connection point) - "Join a nexus"
- **Collective** (shared purpose) - "Start a collective"
- **Commons** (shared space) - "Create a commons"

I liked the idea of not doing what everyone else has done or is doing, especially if this blows up the way we hope it will. This is a choice that we will have to live with, one way or another. Once we start down one path, we won't be able to reorganize as easily as we grow. We also need to consider a potential international audience.

The contextual solution at least starts to divide it up a little so that when people are searching, they can say, "I am interested in a profession-type group of CPAs" and look in Networks, or "I am looking for the Bucknuts drinking folks" in Affinity groups. Or I am looking for a local book club, and I would search Locals.